



SNOWBE ONLINE

System Development Life Cycle Policy



Your name:
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System Development Life
Cycle Policy

Version1

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Purpose

SnowBe Builds and manages systems that handle credit cards, customer accounts, and purchase history. This policy is to ensure security is part of the SDLC from the start to finish so we don't implement risky code or weak configurations. This follows the idea that security practices must be built into the SDLC, not handled later on

Scope

This policy applies to:

- SnowBe's wordpress shopping cart, website code, plugins, themes, and integrations
- AWS-hosted systems and any on-prem servers used for business operations (i.e. AD server)
- Vendor software used for order management, CRM, accounting, and access management.
- Any changes that can impact cardholder data, customer data, or authentication.

Definitions

Term	Definition
AWS (Amazon Web Services)	A cloud platform used to host SnowBe systems.
CISO (Chief Information Security Officer)	Executive responsible for information security.
Least Privilege	Giving users only the access they need to do their job
Logging	Recording system and user activity for monitoring and investigations.
Production Environment	(Live systems used by customers.
Rollback Plan	A plan to undo a change if something breaks.
SDLC (System Development Life Cycle)	The process used to design, build, test, deploy, and maintain systems.
WordPress	A website platform used for SnowBe's online store
Vendor Application	Software provided by a third-party company.

Roles & Responsibilities:

Role	Responsibilities
CISO	Owns the policy, approves risk decisions/exceptions.
IT Manager	Does AWS configs, backups, logging, and infrastructure changes
DEV / WEB team	Builds and maintains the website, plugins, integrations, and follows secure coding procedure
System Owners	Approve business requirements and validate changes so they don't break operations.

Policy

1. Security must be included in all SDLC phases: planning, design, development, testing, deployment, maintenance, and retirement.
2. Security requirements must be documented before system development or major changes.
3. Access must follow least privilege, meaning users only receive access required to perform their job.
4. All production changes must follow an approved change process.
5. Logging must be enabled for user access, administrative activity, and system changes.
6. Customer and payment data retention must be justified and approved.
7. Third-party software, plugins, and vendors must be reviewed before use.

SDLC Security Controls

- Planning: Identify data types, compliance needs, and security requirements.
- Design: Review access, data flow, and system architecture risks.
- Development: Secure coding practices must be followed.
- Testing: Vulnerability scans and functional testing must be completed.
- Deployment: Changes require approval and rollback plans.
- Maintenance: Ongoing monitoring, patching, and access reviews.
- Retirement: Secure data removal and access termination.

Exceptions/Exemptions

Any deviation from this plan must be:

1. Submit deviation form to IT Director
2. Approved by the IT Director
3. Documented with compensating controls
4. Time-limited with a remediation deadline (max of 1 year)

Enforcement

Escalation structure:

- 1. **Verbal Warning** – first minor policy violation
- 2. **Written Warning** – documented repeat violations
- 3. **Suspension of System Access** – short-term, retraining required
- 4. **Job-related Discipline** – reassignment, loss of privileges
- 5. **Termination and Legal Action** – for severe/repeated offenses
- 6. **Criminal Prosecution** – if actions violate state/federal laws

Network or system removal may occur immediately if needed to protect SnowBe systems.

Version History Table

Version #	Implementation Date	Document Owner	Approved By	Description
1.0	20251221	Ethan Platt	SnowBe	Initial SDLC Policy

Citations

<https://its.ny.gov/secure-system-development-life-cycle-standard>